

The Mercy Meditation¹

In this practice we plant seeds of mercy, not only for ourselves, but for others as well.

Mercy Meditation for Oneself

Assume a meditation posture, and breathe. You might wish to take some notes in your KF journal. *(Pause)* Draw your mind away from the events of the day, from the past or the future, and from others. Focus on what is happening inside your skin. Settle into being present and aware in this moment. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

As you reflect on each of the following three questions, observe your feelings and thoughts without judgment, and notice your body's reactions.

1. In what areas am I most critical of myself? *(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause, and jot down what came to mind. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

2. For what do I need to forgive myself? *(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause. You might make a note of your thoughts and feelings. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

3. How do I treat myself when I make a mistake? *(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause, and write down your thoughts and feelings. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

And now, experiment with bringing compassion to yourself in some way. For example, call to mind someone who loves you just as you are. This might be someone divine, like God or Jesus, or perhaps someone mortal and human. You might call to mind one of God's other creatures. *(Pause)* Imagine seeing yourself through their eyes. You might give yourself an appreciative hug. *(Pause)* However you choose to bring compassion to yourself, just observe and rest for one minute. Practice letting go of judgment and breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Mercy Meditation for Others

Assume a meditation posture, and breathe. You might wish to take some notes in your KF journal. *(Pause)* Draw your mind away from the events of the day, from the past or the future, and from others. and focus on what is happening inside your own skin. Settle into being present and aware in this moment. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Allow a person to come to mind to whom you wish to extend mercy, or you might wish to consider a situation in which you find it difficult to extend mercy to someone. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

As you reflect on each of the following three questions, observe your feelings and thoughts without judgment, and notice your body's reactions.

1. In what areas am I most critical of this person? *(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause, and jot down what came to mind. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

2. For what do I need to forgive this person? *(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause. You might make a note of your thoughts and feelings. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

3. How do I treat this person when they make a mistake or do not live up to my standards? *(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause, and write down your thoughts and feelings. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

And now, use your imagination in a healthy way to experiment with bringing compassion to this person. You might call to mind someone who loves this person as they are. This might be someone divine, like God or Jesus, or perhaps someone mortal and human. You might call to mind one of God's other creatures. *(Pause)* As you breathe for one minute, observe whatever comes to mind and practice letting go of judgment. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

¹ www.livingmindfully.org/. Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.